



Measuring your abdomen helps the doctor monitor your baby's growth.

GROWTH CHARTS

If your doctor has concerns about your baby's growth later in pregnancy, they may arrange for scans over a period of time to plot and monitor your baby's growth. Individual measurements will be taken of the head, abdomen, and limbs. Measurements of the head and abdomen are most important since an unequal growth pattern in these areas may indicate a particular problem.

The three lines on the graphs here represent different growth rates. The red line in the center, referred to as the 50th percentile, shows an average pattern of growth. The thinner lines above and below, the 90th and the 10th percentiles, show the top and bottom ranges of normal growth. Since the head and abdominal circumferences are measured over time and plotted on a graph, a pattern of growth becomes clear. Here, the head is growing normally, but growth has slowed in the abdomen, possibly due to a placental problem that in itself may be caused by a condition in